

Emergency Preparedness and Response Procedure

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure identifies foreseeable emergency situations relevant to Overleaf Publishers Ltd's activities and establishes planned responses to protect people, preserve data and business assets, and fulfil regulatory obligations. It applies to all personnel, contractors, and, where relevant, learners. Document reference: HSW-003.

2. IDENTIFIED EMERGENCY SCENARIOS

SCENARIO	PRIMARY RISK
Personal medical emergency (staff or contractor)	Injury or death; failure to summon emergency services promptly
Fire or premises emergency	Injury; loss of equipment and data held on physical devices
Cyber attack / ransomware	Data breach; platform unavailability; financial loss; regulatory penalty
Personal data breach	UK GDPR breach; ICO notification obligation; individual harm
Platform catastrophic failure or data loss	Loss of learner access; potential data loss; reputational damage
Loss or incapacity of sole director	Business continuity failure; inability to fulfil regulatory obligations
Severe weather or natural event affecting personnel	Injury; inability to access systems; communication failure
Violent or threatening behaviour (online or in person)	Personal safety; data security if account compromised

3. EMERGENCY RESPONSE ACTIONS BY SCENARIO

Personal medical emergency:

- Call 999 immediately. Do not delay to report internally first.
- Provide first aid if trained and it is safe to do so.
- Notify the Director (or, if the Director is the casualty, the emergency contact on record).
- Log the incident in the Incident Register and notify HSE under RIDDOR if required.

Fire or premises emergency:

- Evacuate the premises immediately following the building's evacuation procedure.
- Call 999. Do not attempt to fight a fire unless trained and it is safe to do so.
- Ensure devices are locked before evacuating where it is safe and quick to do so.
- Account for all personnel; notify emergency services of any missing persons.
- Notify the Director; activate Business Continuity Plan if premises are unavailable.

Cyber attack / ransomware:

- Isolate affected systems immediately — disconnect from network where possible.
- Do not pay any ransom demand without taking specialist legal and security advice.
- Activate Data Breach and Incident Response Procedure.
- Preserve evidence; engage specialist incident response if required.
- Notify ICO within 72 hours if personal data is involved.

Loss or incapacity of sole director:

- Nominated emergency contact (held in sealed emergency instructions) to be activated.
- Emergency instructions provide access to: platform admin credentials (secure method); key contact details for IIRSM, payment processors, and legal/financial advisers; instructions for learner communication.
- Business Continuity Plan Section 4 (Loss of Key Personnel) to be followed.

4. EMERGENCY CONTACT INFORMATION

CONTACT	DETAILS
Emergency services (all)	999
NHS non-emergency / medical advice	111
HSE Incident Contact Centre (RIDDOR)	0345 300 9923
ICO (data breach notification)	ico.org.uk/report-a-breach · 0303 123 1113
Forestry Commission (plant health emergencies)	0300 067 4454
Director (business emergency)	info@chainsawcourses.com
Replit support (platform emergency)	support.replit.com
Vimeo support (video emergency)	vimeo.com/help

5. DRILLS AND TESTING

Emergency response procedures are reviewed annually. The following scenarios are tested at least every 2 years via tabletop or practical exercise: cyber incident response; platform data loss and recovery; loss of sole director. Test outcomes are documented and gaps raised as improvement actions.

6. COMMUNICATION DURING EMERGENCIES

During any emergency affecting platform availability or learner data: learners are notified via in-platform banner and direct email within 2 hours of declaration; IIRSM and RoSPA are notified within 24 hours if the event is likely to affect course approval compliance; the ICO is notified within 72 hours of any personal data breach. All communications are documented and filed.

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